Meridian Crest Bank Holdings, Inc.

Second Quarter 2026 Earnings Call Transcript

Company: Meridian Crest Bank Holdings, Inc.

Ticker: MCBH

Date: August 6, 2026

Participants: Elena Marlowe, Chief Executive Officer; David Chen, Chief Financial Officer; Investor Analysts

FICTIONAL SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT

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Operator

Good morning. This synthetic call is for the second quarter ended June 30, 2026. Statements regarding future performance are forward-looking and involve risks and uncertainties. All figures discussed are fictional and intended for the FinSight AI training corpus.

Elena Marlowe, Chief Executive Officer

We generated $1.31 billion of revenue and $0.30 billion of net income in the second quarter. Loan growth was broad-based, deposit retention remained strong, and the net interest margin improved to 3.51%. We remain attentive to office-related commercial real estate, but criticized assets are stable and remain manageable. Digital engagement continues to improve, and our AI-assisted service tools reduced average handling time by 11%.

David Chen, Chief Financial Officer

Compared with the prior-year quarter, revenue increased primarily from higher loan balances and fee income. Expense growth was contained despite elevated technology investment. Provision expense was $80 million, and the allowance coverage ratio improved modestly. Capital remained strong at 12.6% CET1. For the full year, we continue to target net interest income growth of 5% to 7% and an efficiency ratio below 55%.

Analyst Q&A;

Analyst 1: How are you thinking about commercial real estate risk?

CEO: We are most cautious in office properties outside the strongest central business districts. We have increased monitoring frequency and stress-tested collateral values. Our current loss assumptions remain below the levels that would require a major change to capital planning.

Analyst 2: What is driving the margin improvement?

CFO: The improvement reflects loan repricing and a modestly better deposit mix. We are not assuming the pace continues indefinitely because funding costs remain sensitive to market rates.

Analyst 3: Where is AI creating measurable value?

CEO: The clearest near-term value is internal productivity. Document summarization, service-ticket triage, and coding assistance have reduced manual work. We are cautious about customer-facing recommendations and require human oversight for material decisions.

Closing Remarks

The company reiterated full-year 2026 net interest income growth of 5% to 7% and efficiency ratio below 55%, subject to market and execution conditions. Management emphasized disciplined capital allocation, technology modernization, and risk management.

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